Econometrics 1 — Problem Set 3

Submission Deadline: Thursday, October 15th, 2026 at 1:00 PM | Instructor: Liam Wren-Lewis, TA: Elisa Alonso Herrero

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0.1 Overview & Group Work Division

- **Exercise 1 (Theoretical / Reading Critique):**
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0.2 Computer Exercise (Empirical Analysis in R):

1 Exercise 1: Theoretical & Reading Questions

> **!** Classmates' Assignment
>
> This section contains Exercise 1 (Part A and Part B). Space has been allocated below for your classmates to fill in their solutions and write-ups.

1.1 Part A: Article Critique

Reading: *"Legal determinants of World Cup Success"* (by Mark West).

1.1.1 Question 1: Econometric Strategy & Gauss-Markov Critique

Formulate a critique related to the econometric strategy used in the paper. Think about which of the Gauss-Markov assumptions might be violated in the regressions and what that tells you about the interpretation of the results. Limit your critique to one page.

> **i** Answer — Exercise 1.A.1
>
> **Violated Gauss-Markov Assumptions & Implications:**
>
> - **Zero Conditional Mean Assumption $E(u|X) = 0$ (Omitted Variable Bias):**
> - **Homoskedasticity / Uncorrelated Errors:**
> - **Interpretation of Coefficients:**

1.1.2 Question 2: Reliability of Estimations

The 4 different estimations in this paper seem to lead to quite different results. If you wanted to conclude anything related to the determinants of World Cup soccer success, would you rely on any of these estimations? If so, on which one?

Answer — Exercise 1.A.2

Assessment:

1.2 Part B: True or False

Missing observations can lead to both biased estimates and imprecise estimates. T/F? Explain.

Answer — Exercise 1.B

Statement: [True / False]
Explanation:

- **Biased Estimates:**
- **Imprecise Estimates:**

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2 Computer Exercise: Empirical Analysis in R

Your Assignment

This section contains the 7 empirical questions using the dataset `nichh.dta`. Code chunks are prepared below for execution in VS Code / R.

2.1 Data Setup & Model Estimation

Dataset: `nichh.dta` (subset of 1998 Nicaragua LSMS dataset, 582 households).

Task: Estimate a log-linear model that allows understanding the *ceteris paribus* relationships between total household consumption (in logs) and household head's age, head's education, male and female labor endowments, land endowments, and distances to the health clinic and school.

2.2 Question (1): Education Significance

What is the minimum significance level at which one can reject the hypothesis that the education level of the household head does not affect total household consumption?

i Answer — Question (1)

As shown in Table 1, the coefficient of the household head's education is statistically significant at the 1% significant level, with a p-value of $< 2e-16$ (almost zero). This means the minimum significance level at which we can reject the null hypothesis that the education level of the household head does not affect total household consumption is $< 2e-16$.

2.3 Question (2): Male vs. Female Labor Returns

Do your results allow you to conclude the returns to male adults in the household are larger than the returns to female adults? State the null hypothesis and the alternative hypothesis you are testing, and the significance level you are considering. Do the test and discuss. Does your answer differ depending on which significance level you consider?

i Answer — Question (2)

Table 1: Log-Linear model summary. Dependent variable: log(total household consumption).

	Log-Linear Model
Intercept	9.178 ***
	(0.108) [p = 0.000]
Number of male adults	0.115 ***
	(0.025) [p = 0.000]
Number of female adults	0.195 ***
	(0.025) [p = 0.000]
Age of household head (years)	0.006 ***
	(0.002) [p = 0.000]
Education of household head (years)	0.066 ***
	(0.005) [p = 0.000]
Land owned (ha)	0.004 ***
	(0.001) [p = 0.000]
Distance to health centre (km)	-0.011
	(0.010) [p = 0.294]
Distance to school (km)	-0.020 *
	(0.011) [p = 0.080]
N	575
R2	0.354

Significance: *** p < 0.01; ** p < 0.05; * p < 0.1

2.4 Question (3): Joint Significance of Distance Variables

Test whether the 2 distance variables are jointly significant. Calculate the test by hand (using R). What can you conclude about the role of isolation on household welfare?

i Answer — Question (3)

2.5 Question (4): Correlation Between Education and Age

Analyze the correlation between households' education and age. What does this correlation imply for your estimates? If you are estimating this model to obtain an estimate of the returns to household's heads education on household welfare, should you keep household age in the model?

> **i** Answer — Question (4)

2.6 Question (5): Testing Coefficient equal to 0.06

Test whether the coefficient of education is different from 0.06.

> **i** Answer — Question (5)

2.7 Question (6): Outliers in Land Area Variable

Look at the distribution of the landarea variable. Then re-estimate the model excluding households with more than 100 ha. Analyze the change of the coefficient of the land area variable compared to the previous regression. Explain.

> **i** Answer — Question (6)

2.8 Question (7): Omitted Variable Thought Experiment

Give an example of an additional variable you might want to include in the regression, but for which you don't have data, and indicate the expected effect of that variable, as well as any changes you would anticipate to occur in the point estimates of the other variables.

Answer — Question (7)